

Chapter 2. Architecture

2.1. Overview

Matter aims to build a universal IPv6-based communication protocol for smart home devices. The protocol defines the application layer that will be deployed on devices as well as the different link layers to help maintain interoperability. The following [diagram](#) illustrates the normal operational mode of the stack:

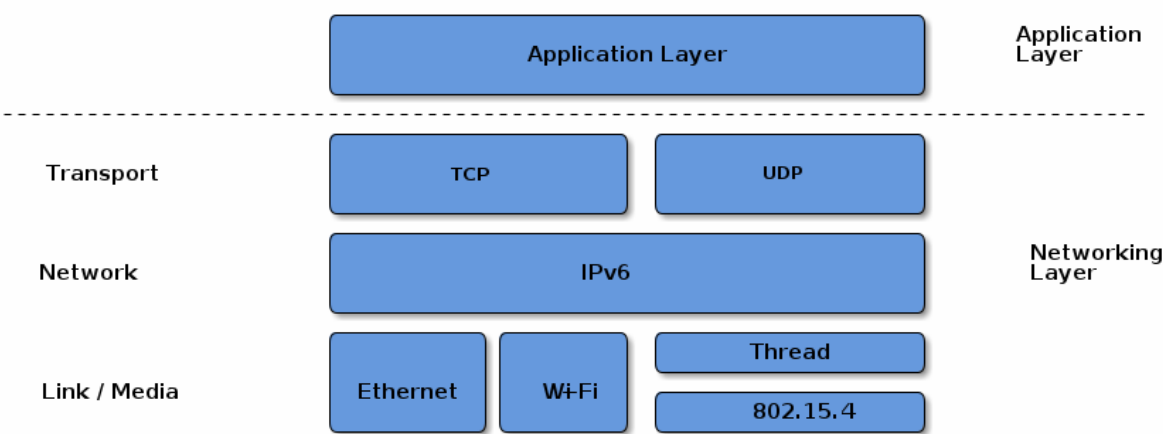


Figure 1. Application and Network Stack

2.2. Layered Architecture

The architecture is divided into layers to help separate the different responsibilities and introduce a good level of encapsulation amongst the various pieces of the protocol stack. The vast majority of interactions flow through the stack captured in the following [Figure](#).